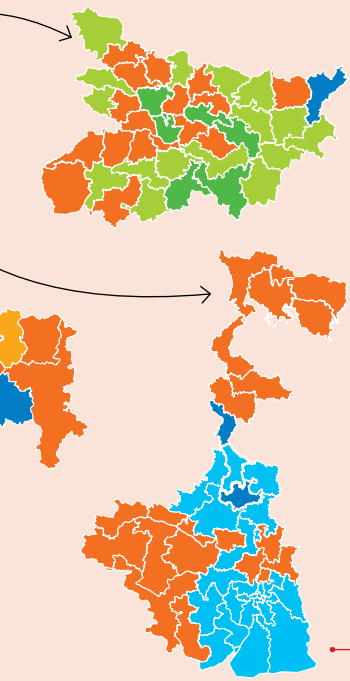
130

NUMBER OF LOK SABHA SEATS IN THESE THREE STATES

98

SEATS THE BJP-LED NDA WON IN 2019, A STRIKE RATE OF 75%

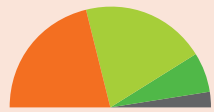


BIHAR

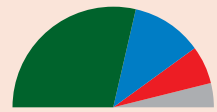
(Total seats: 40)

The Congress-RJD alliance is intact; after its crossover to the Mahagathbandhan in 2022, the JD(U) has returned to the NDA

IN THE FRAY



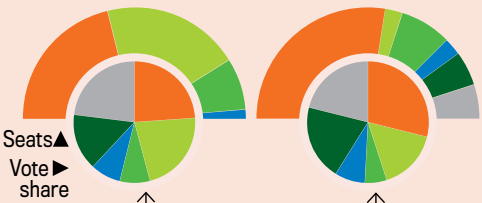
NDA
- BJP **17**
- JD(U) **16**
- LJP(RV) **5**
- Others **2**



MAHAGATHBANDHAN (INDIA BLOC)
- RJD **23**
- Congress **9**
- Left **5**
- Others **3**

(Figures denote seats being contested)

PAST RESULTS



	2019	2014
BJP	**17**/17 (24%)	**22**/30 (29%)
JD (U)	**16**/17 (22%)	**2**/38 (16%)
LJP	**6**/6 (8%)	**6**/7 (6%)
Congress	**1**/9 (8%)	**2**/12 (8%)
RJD	**0**/19 (15%)	**4**/27 (20%)
Others	**0** (23%)	**4** (21%)

SEATS WON/ CONTESTED (VOTE SHARE)

WEST BENGAL

(Total seats: 42)

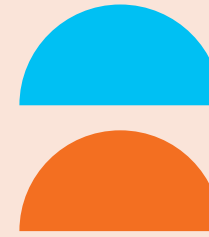
Two INDIA constituents—the Congress and the Left—have reached a seat-sharing pact, while the TMC has stayed away. It will contest all seats, just like the BJP

IN THE FRAY



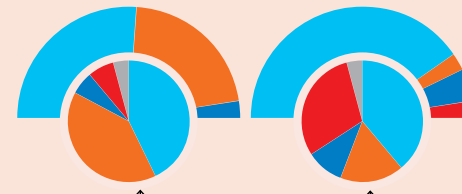
INDIA BLOC
- Congress **12**
- Left **30**

(Figures denote seats being contested)



NO ALLIANCE
- TMC **42**
- BJP **42**

PAST RESULTS



	2019	2014
TMC	**22**/42 (43%)	**34**/42 (39%)
BJP	**18**/42 (40%)	**2**/42 (17%)
Congress	**2**/40 (6%)	**4**/42 (10%)
Left	**0**/41 (7%)	**2**/42 (30%)
Others	**0** (4%)	**0** (4%)

(Vote share figures are rounded off)

Graphics by **TANMOY CHAKRABORTY**

TO REACH 370, THE BJP WILL HAVE TO RETAIN THE 58 SEATS IT WON IN THESE STATES IN 2019 AND POTENTIALLY ADD ANOTHER 29–24 FROM WEST BENGAL ALONE

from two seats in 2014 to an astounding 18. With a vote share difference of just three percentage points, the saffron party had established itself as the TMC's prime challenger, overtaking the Red brigade.

Altogether, the BJP had won 58 out of the 84 seats it contested in these three states in 2019—a strike rate of 70 per cent. This time, it is imperative for the BJP to retain these seats. This tally had not only helped the party cross the majority mark of 272 on its own but to do so with an impressive overall count of 303 seats. And if Modi's target is for the BJP to win a brute majority of 370 seats in 2024, then there is potential to win another 29 seats, 24 in West Bengal alone, with the party contesting 87 seats in these three states. For the regional satraps, it is essential that they combine forces with their allies and push down the BJP-NDA tally significantly in their own fiefdoms to ensure that they live to fight another day. If they strategise well enough, shave 30-odd seats off the BJP's 2019 tally and push it below the majority